



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 5



GS – I ... WORLD HISTORY

- 1 The benefits which can accrue to the global GDP through “orderly international migration” are stymied by “fear and apprehensions”. Do you agree? Give reasoned arguments. (150 Words)
- 2 The fall of the Berlin Wall is considered as a “historic moment”, which altered the trajectory of socialist countries. Critically analyse the transformation in these socialist countries in political and economic spheres. Did this transformation lead to India’s tilt towards USA? Argue. (250 Words)
- 3 Several Western Countries, which are formed based on the basic tenets of “freedom, democracy, equality, rule of law and human rights” are facing huge challenges to these fundamental traits. Examine critically why these are under threat. (250 Words)

GS – II ... SOCIAL JUSTICE & GOVERNANCE

- 7 “Poor quality public goods / services and poor resource mobilisation through taxes in urban areas is resulting in a low-level equilibrium trap”. Suggest various measures - social, political and economical – to come out of this loop. (250 Words)
- 8 “The digital divide between the haves and have-nots in 21st Century has more serious repercussions than the divide between literates and illiterates at the time of Independence”. Do you agree with the statement? Give reasoned arguments. (150 Words)
- 9 India is facing a situation of overflowing granaries in Public Distribution System on one hand and is home to the highest percentage of wasted children globally on the other hand. How do you explain this paradox? (150 Words)

GS – III ... ENVIRONMENT & DISASTER MANAGEMENT

- 4 In recent times, the perceived inaction on “climate change-related issues” by the Governments in developed countries resulted in unprecedented protests across the Globe. Do you justify these protests? How the responsibilities of developed and developing countries are different in this context? (250 Words)
- 5 How the flora and fauna of Eastern Himalayas is different from that of Western Himalayas? Analyse the threats faced by the diverse ecosystem of Eastern Himalayas. (250 Words)
- 6 List out four prominent locations of coral reefs in India, along with the distinct threats faced by each one of them. (150 Words)

GS – IV ...ETHICS & INTEGRITY

13

Analyze the essence and determinants of ethics in human action? (250 Words)

14

Discuss the characteristics of an ideal citizen charter. What are the duties of civil servants with regard to citizen charter? (250 Words)

15

What is National Interest? Elaborate on principle ethical determinants of good and bad in International Relations. (150 Words)

The benefits which can accrue to the global GDP through “orderly international migration” are stymied by “fear and apprehensions”. Do you agree? Give reasoned arguments. (150 Words)

UN Global compact for safe, orderly and regular migration (2018) is a step towards humane and orderly management of migration. But lack of consensus exhibits the opposition that can stymie the benefits associated with migration.

BENEFITS AND FEARS

BENEFITS

- Migrants comprise only about 3.4% of global population but contribute more than 9% of GDP.
- Boost demand in host countries by spending.
- Play a major role in remittances in developing countries.
- Complement the ageing work force in developing countries and thus sustaining their economic activity.
- Transfer of technology and innovation to developing countries as they return.
- Provide services like security, domestic maid etc.

FEARS

- Threat to availability of limited resources to sustain
- Job loss to the citizens of host countries
- Threat to indigenous cultures and traditions
- May lead to increased crime rate as the migrants are perceived backward
- Fiscal burden on host countries and depressing wages for low skilled native workers
- Increasing lone wolf attacks and terror activities further aggravating the fears

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CONCLUSION

The trend of increasing migration is set to continue. Fragmented migration policies based on unfounded fears will hamper the development that migration creates. A coordinated approach as envisioned in global compact is must for sustainable and inclusive development.

The fall of the Berlin Wall is considered as a “historic moment”, which altered the trajectory of socialist countries. Critically analyse the transformation in these socialist countries in political and economic spheres. Did this transformation lead to India’s tilt towards USA? Argue. (250 Words)

Berlin Wall, which fell on November 9, 1989, represents the ideological divide of the bipolar world and the resulting Cold War era. Post Berlin Wall collapse, the socialist countries that were earlier under USSR have witnessed political and economic transformations.

TRANSFORMATION IN SOCIALIST COUNTRIES

POLITICAL SPHERE

- Soviet imposed communist regimes toppled, following protests and political movements
- USSR, Yugoslavia were divided
- Many communist countries joined EU bloc
- Ideals of freedom and liberty prevailed
- Shift from bipolar to unipolar world and then to multipolar in present times
- Advent of transactional regime in international relations

SOCIALIST COUNTRIES

ECONOMIC SPHERE

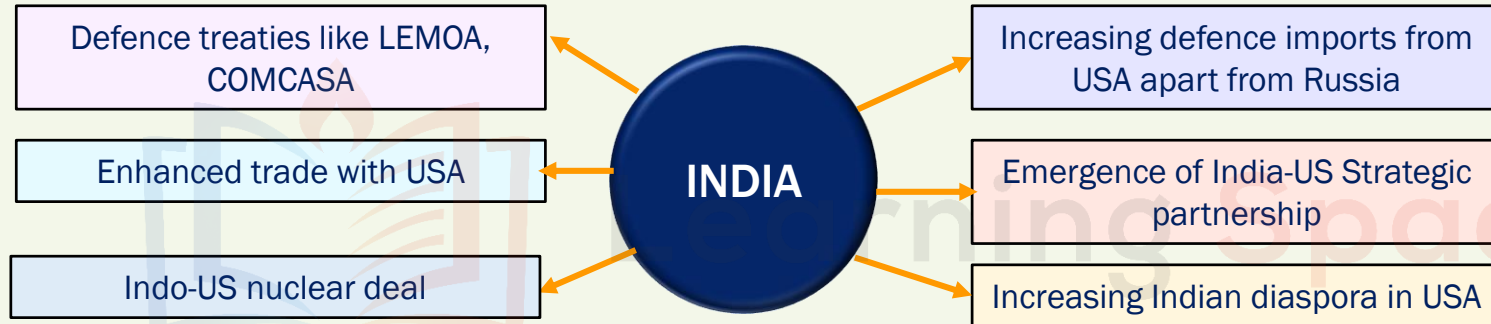
- Globalization embraced all the nations
- China emerged as manufacturing giant
- Socialist countries embraced market socialism while capitalist countries allowed State intervention
- Emergence of EU as an economic and monetary union
- Advent of mixed economy regimes in global economy



IMPACT ON INDIA

With the fall of USSR and resilient efforts of socialist economies to become normal, India's foreign policy started according more priority to the west that includes USA.

TILT TOWARDS USA



CONCLUSION

With the rise of unbalanced multipolar global order, multi alignments and strategic autonomy in international relations have become the new normal.

Several Western Countries, which are formed based on the basic tenets of “freedom, democracy, equality, rule of law and human rights” are facing huge challenges to these fundamental traits. Examine critically why these are under threat. (250 Words)

Revolutions based on fundamental traits of freedom, equality, rule of law, human rights resulted in establishment of strong western democracies. Ideals like freedom, equality and no taxation without representation emerged from French revolution and American revolution respectively. But these traits are under threat in the same western societies in recent times.

REASONS FOR FUNDAMENTAL TRAITS UNDER THREAT

1. FREEDOM

- Increasing surveillance attitude of States
Eg: USA using face recognition technologies to collect civilian data
- Rise of Conservative governments
Eg: Increasing racist remarks in US politics
- Debt ridden economies like Greece forcing people to adopt austere measures.

2. EQUALITY

- Unfair resource distribution by the governments
Eg: Catalonia's secessionist movement in Spain
- Fears against immigrants
Eg: Germans not supporting immigration policies, Brexit to restrict immigration
- Economic injustice due to huge income disparities
Eg: Yellow vest movement in France, Gender wage inequalities in western companies like Google, Apple and Facebook etc.

3. RULE OF LAW

- Threats to judicial independence
Eg: Legislation's weakening judicial independence in Poland and Hungary.
- Deviations in ensuring free and fair elections affecting democratic principles
Eg: Alleged hacking and efforts to interfere in USA elections

4. HUMAN RIGHTS

- Rise of protectionism
Eg: Racist attacks across west and detention camps in USA
- Hatred towards immigrants
Eg: Anti-immigration violence in Germany

THE WAY AHEAD

- Enabling these fundamental traits is necessary for a healthy democracy to sustain and achieve progressive transformations.
- Civil society and state should come together to create awareness about the threats to these traits and re-enact laws considering the present realities to protect these fundamental traits.



“Poor quality public goods / services and poor resource mobilisation through taxes in urban areas is resulting in a low-level equilibrium trap”. Suggest various measures - social, political and economical – to come out of this loop. (250 Words)

Despite completing 25 years of establishing urban local bodies (ULBs), they remain to be in low equilibrium for varied reasons, affecting fiscal federalism.



REASONS FOR LOW-LEVEL EQUILIBRIUM TRAP

- Overlap of administrative functions
- Poor financial decentralization
- Absence of technology mediated evidence-based tax collection
- Lack of resource mobilization through means like urban bonds
- Poor participation and awareness among citizens in governance
- Huge dependence of States for funds devolution
- Absence of financial autonomy to collect even delegated tax, unless permitted by States

MEASURES TO PREVENT LOW-LEVEL EQUILIBRIUM TRAP

POLITICAL

- Dedicated list of separation of subjects between the State and the ULB
- Legislative decentralization by giving law making power to lower level

ADMINISTRATIVE

- Parastatals should not undermine ULBs
- Specialized trained cadre to cater to complex needs of local governance
Eg: Village secretariat in Andhra Pradesh
- Implementing Citizen Charter

ECONOMIC

- Enable financial autonomy to collect taxes
- Financial support for investments in urban bonds

TECHNOLOGICAL

- Satellite maps and smart metering to trace tax evasion and increase tax collection efficiency

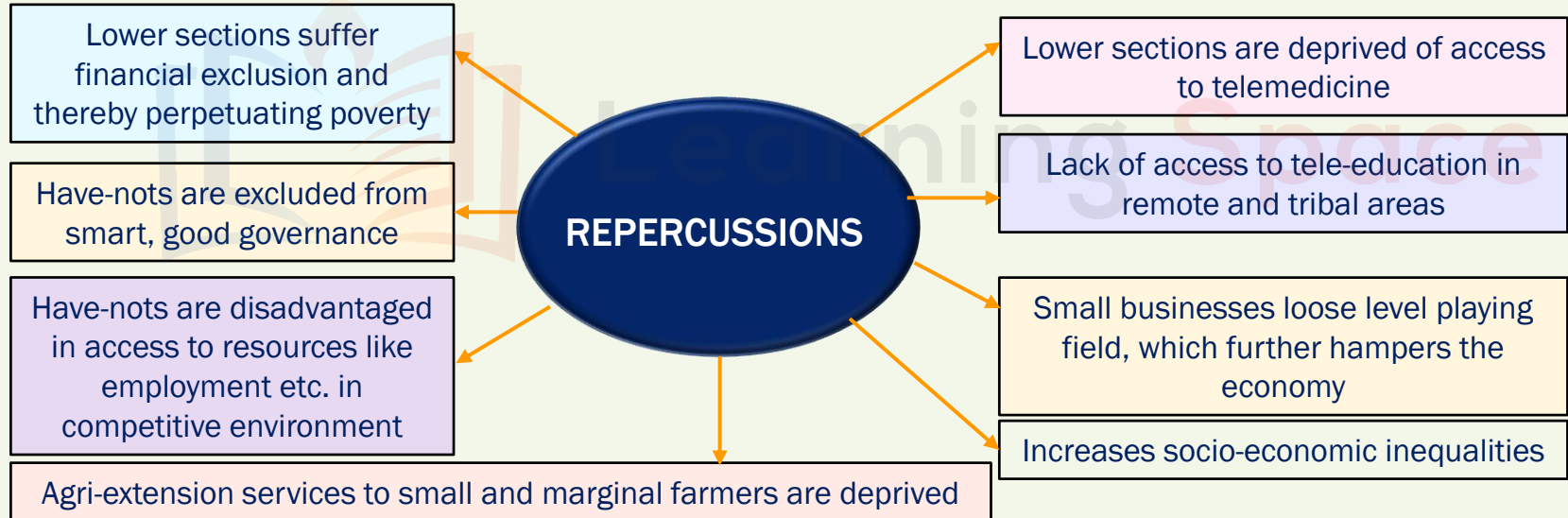
CONCLUSION

Strong ULBs bring equality, livability and democratic governance in urban transformation. Implementation of these measures in letter and spirit is the need of the hour.

“The digital divide between the haves and have-nots in 21st Century has more serious repercussions than the divide between literates and illiterates at the time of Independence”. Do you agree with the statement? Give reasoned arguments. (150 Words)

UN Declaration of Internet as a basic human right emphasizes the transformative role that digital technology plays in 21st Century human lives. With the nation embracing digital India, the digital divide between haves and have-nots is a major challenge in dealing with inequalities, poverty and socio-economic development.

REPERCUSSIONS DUE TO DIGITAL DIVIDE BETWEEN HAVES AND HAVE-NOTS



CONCLUSION

- Effective implementation of schemes like PMGDISHA with active participation from lower sections of the society is imperative.
- Enabling internet penetration into rural areas with efficient communication infrastructure should precede the implementation of digital India initiatives.



Learning Space

India is facing a situation of overflowing granaries in Public Distribution System on one hand and is home to the highest percentage of wasted children globally on the other hand. How do you explain this paradox? (150 Words)

While the stock of food grains under central procurement pool is higher than recommended limits, India remained home to highest number of wasted children. According to NFHS 2016, Anaemia among children under 5 years and reproductive women is more than 50%.

REASONS FOR SUCH PARADOX

- 1) Exclusion of nutrient foods like pulses, eggs, milk etc. in national food security policies
- 2) Poor convergence among various ministries in delivery of nutrition and health service
- 3) Not addressing multiple dimensions of undernutrition like -
 - Poverty and affordability of nutrient foods
 - Awareness about healthy food diet
 - Inequitable food distribution
 - Improper maternal, infant and childcare practices
 - Gender imbalances driven by cultural attitudes
 - Poor sanitary and environmental conditions
 - Lack of access to quality health services

THE WAY FORWARD

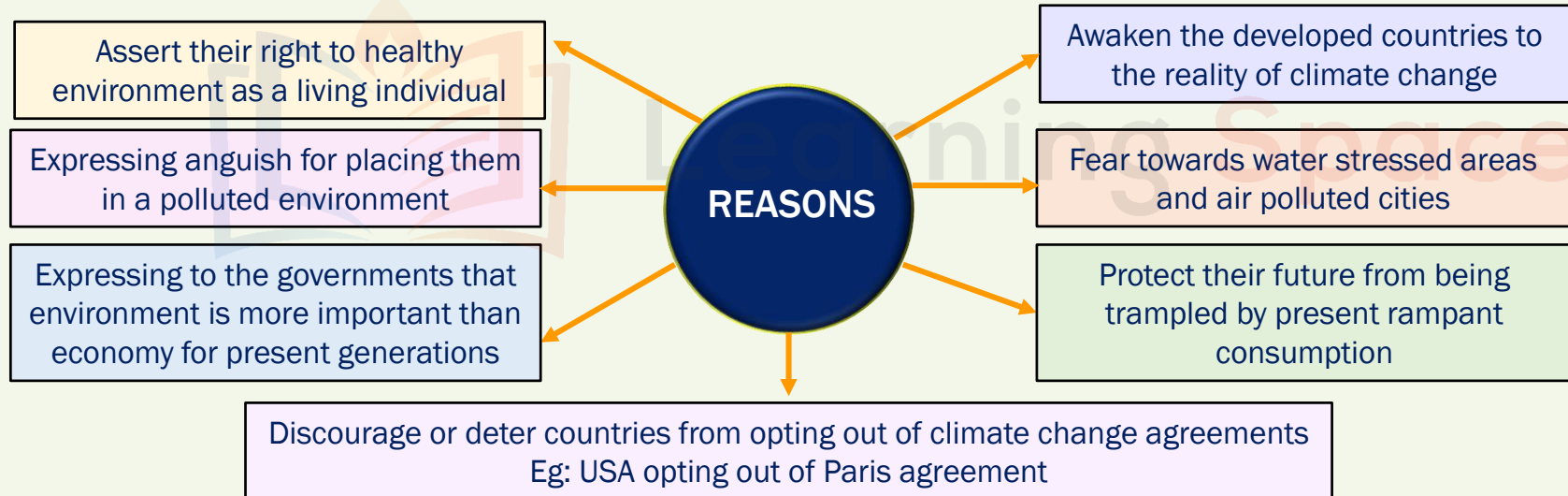
- Shift policy focus towards nutri-cereals, fish, egg etc.
- Encourage food fortification
- Increase proteins and micronutrients content in TPDS, Mid-day meals, ICDS etc.
- Participation of lower sections in these reforms is the need of the hour



In recent times, the perceived inaction on “climate change-related issues” by the Governments in developed countries resulted in unprecedented protests across the Globe. Do you justify these protests? How the responsibilities of developed and developing countries are different in this context? (250 Words)

New environmental protests like “Extinction Rebellion”, “Fridays for Future” are a result of inaction by developed countries towards climate breakdown, bio-diversity loss and the risk of social and ecological collapse.

REASONS FOR SUCH PROTESTS



IAS MAINS 2020 - VALUE ADDITION

Because of historical injustices suffered by developing countries in attaining technological advancements and developments, responsibilities towards climate change differ between developed and developing countries.

RESPONSIBILITIES

DEVELOPED

DEVELOPING

1. CONTRIBUTION

More contribution to present pollution because of early industrialization

Less contribution to present pollution due to delay in industrialization

2. STANDARD OF LIVING

Citizens enjoy higher per capita income and better standards of living

More citizens are yet to achieve better standards of living

3. POVERTY & PRESENT ECONOMY

Less poor and not agrarian based. Thus, shifting to Green economy is necessary

More poor and largely agrarian based. Shifting to Green economy can further affect the poor majority

4. TECHNOLOGY & FUNDS

Access and availability of technology & funds to shift to Green economy

Lack of technology & funds to shift to Green economy

CONCLUSION

While it is the moral imperative for developed countries to take larger responsibilities, it is the right and existential necessity for developing countries to take lesser responsibility initially.



How the flora and fauna of Eastern Himalayas is different from that of Western Himalayas? Analyse the threats faced by the diverse ecosystem of Eastern Himalayas. (250 Words)

The geographic and climatic differences between Western and Eastern Himalayas resulted in different adaptative conditions for flora and fauna. This led to distinct flora and fauna, although with some overlap, in these regions.

FLORA & FAUNA

WESTERN HIMALAYAS

- Adapted to snow mountains and cold deserts in western region
- Moderate to less rainfall along with four distinct Himalayan ranges leading to flora and fauna of mostly Temperate to Alpine forests
- Vegetation of forest soils mostly
- Comparatively less protected areas for flora and fauna
- Fauna like Snow leopard, Himalayan Brown Bear, Pashmina goat are more prominent.

EASTERN HIMALAYAS

- Adapted to thick forests along the low hills of Purvanchal ranges
- Heavy to moderate rainfall from South-West and North-East monsoons resulted in flora and fauna of mostly tropical forests
- Vegetation of alluvial, red and yellow, laterite and forest soils prevail
- More protected areas for flora and fauna
- Fauna like Rhinoceros, Hoolock Gibbons, Sangai deer etc. are more prominent.



THREATS TO EASTERN HIMALAYAN ECOSYSTEM



THE WAY AHEAD

- Despite these threats, community conservation efforts across Eastern and Western Himalayas like Snow leopard conservation in Ladakh and Bugun Liocichla conservation in Arunachal Pradesh are positive promising steps to protect and preserve the Himalayan ecosystem.
- Considering fragility of this ecosystem in development policy making by the Government is necessary.

List out four prominent locations of coral reefs in India, along with the distinct threats faced by each one of them. (150 Words)

Coral reefs are shallow water, tropical marine ecosystems with high biomass production and rich faunal and floral diversity. Prominent locations of coral reefs in India include:

OFFSHORE ISLANDS

- Lakshadweep (Atolls)
- Andaman and Nicobar Islands (fringing reefs)

MAINLAND COAST

- Gulf of Kutch (fringing reefs)
- Palk Bay and Gulf of Mannar (fringing reefs and Atolls)

DISTINCT THREATS TO THESE REGIONS

1. LAKSHADWEEP

- Population pressure
- Coral and shingle extraction from constructions
- Garbage and sewage disposal
- Blasting and dredging in lagoons for navigation channels
- Increasing waste due to tourism
- Anchor damage by tourist boats



2. ANDAMAN AND NICOBAR ISLANDS

- Siltation due to logging
- Sand mining
- High threat in South Andaman due to dense population
- Growing industrialization increased discharge of sewage and effluents into the ecosystem
- Ornament trade and Commercial exploitation of fishes
- Tourists induced damage

3. GULF OF KUTCH

- Commercial exploitation of coral sands by cement industry
- Felling of mangroves
- Increased sediment load
- Unsustainable fishing practices
- Population pressure of fishing community

4. PALK BAY AND GULF OF MANNAR

- Use of trawl nets for fishing and grill nets for lobsters
- Coral mining for calcium carbonate industry
- Population pressure and untreated sewage disposal

THE WAY AHEAD

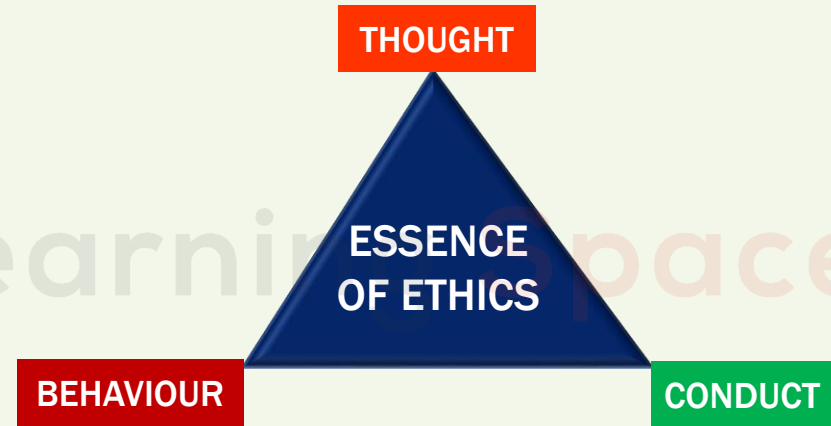
Policies on coastal regulation and wildlife protection have to include sustainable conservative approach towards coral reefs. Region specific policies and effective implementation is the key.



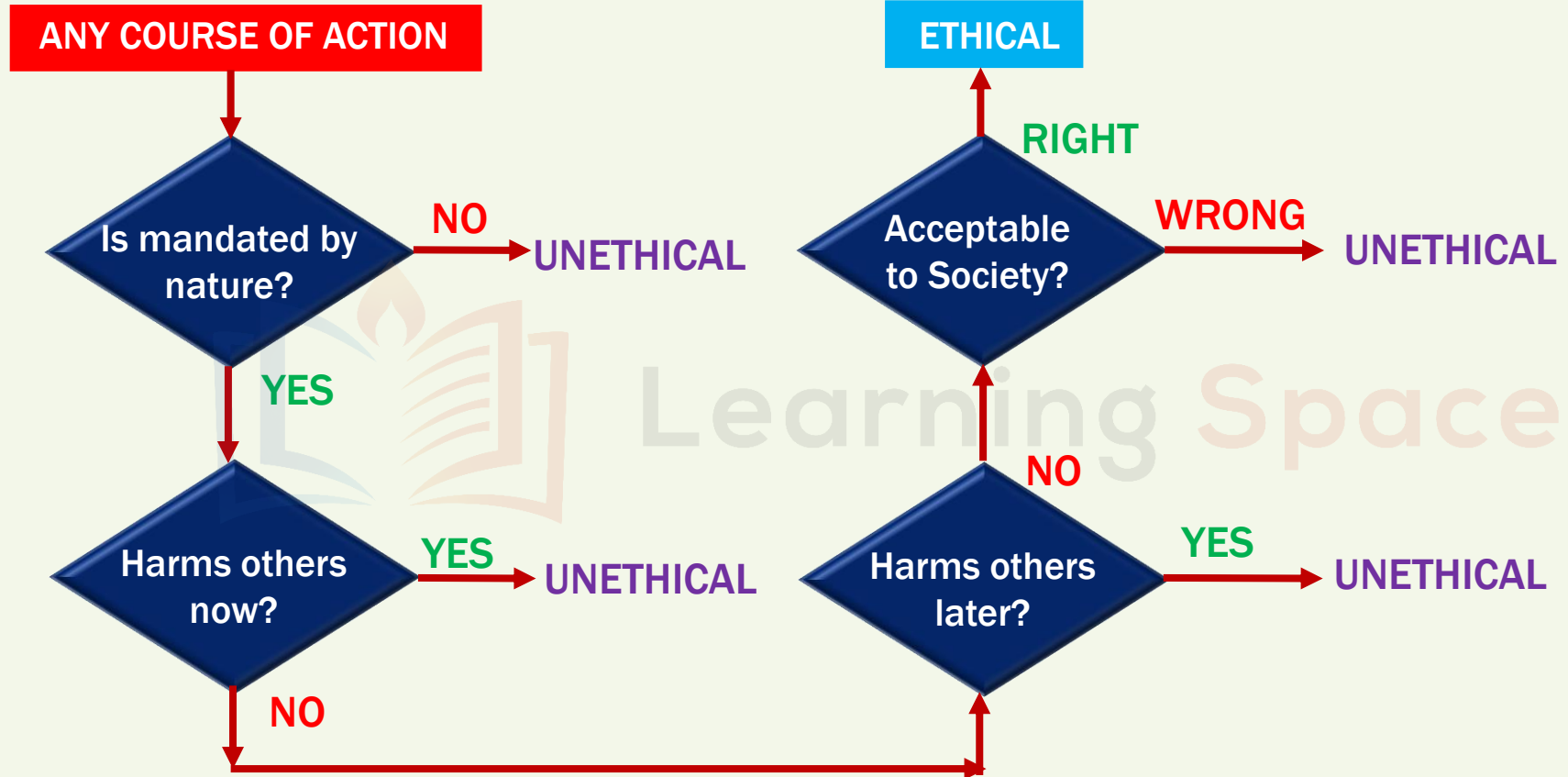
Analyze the essence and determinants of ethics in human action? (250 Words)

Ethics are a set of principles that guide human actions in a way acceptable to the society. They act as a guiding light pertaining to what right and wrong is.

Essence of ethics in human action implies observance of principles of good versus bad in the thought, behaviour and conduct of an individual.



ETHICS IN HUMAN ACTION



DETERMINANTS OF ETHICS

Determinants are the factors that cause ethics in human action. They include:

- **Personality:**
 - Traits and behavior of an individual that are inborn or inculcated.
 - E.g.: A person with the trait of integrity will never cross the red traffic signal despite absence of police or during night time.
- **Family:**
 - Early personality during childhood is developed by emulating the parents.
- **Peer Group:**
 - Because of similar age or profession and amount of time that an individual spends with peers, his/her ethics can be influenced.
 - E.g.: Gandhiji in his childhood took to drinking, smoking, lying etc. because of bad peer group.
- **Episodic events:**
 - Some profound incidents in life can erase past influences and kindle an urge to transform.
 - E.g.: In the Angulimala story, the murderer transforms into a saint after meeting Buddha.
- **Situation:**
 - E.g.: Presence of a strict officer can force subordinate staff to abstain from corruption.
- Professional code, customs etc.

CONCLUSION

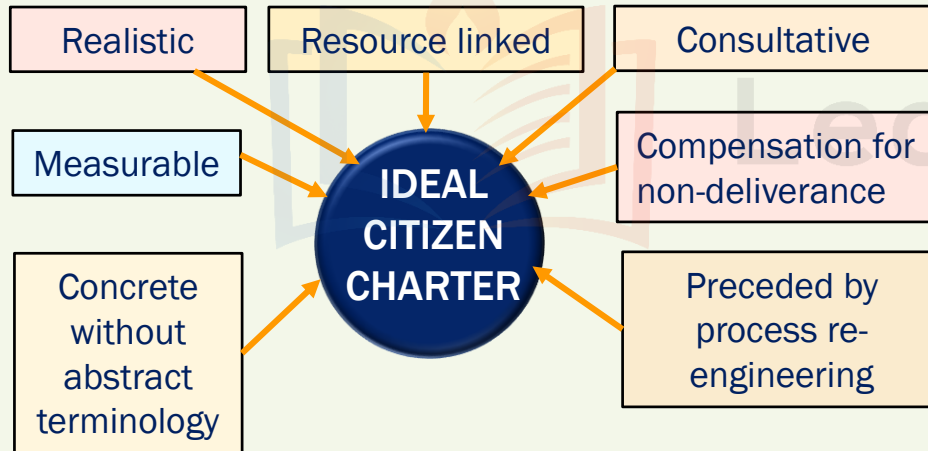
Enabling ethics in human action results in efficient justice delivery and progressive society. Ethical governance can be enabled by ensuring ethics in the process of administration.



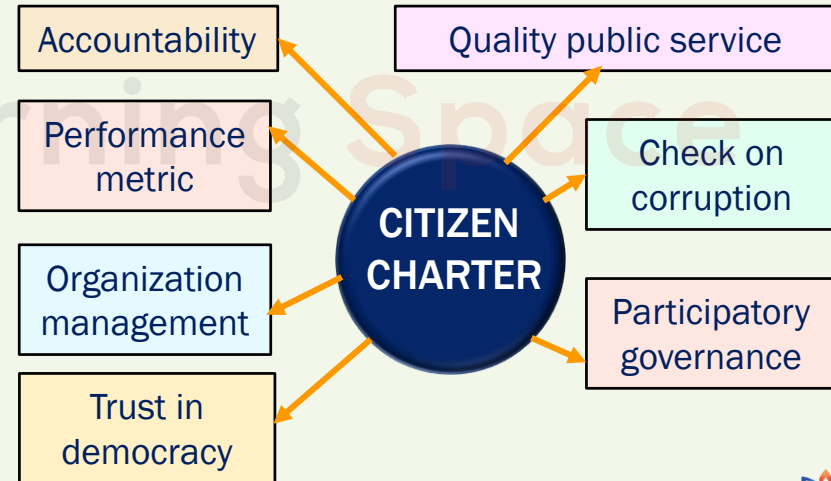
Discuss the characteristics of an ideal citizen charter. What are the duties of civil servants with regard to citizen charter? (250 Words)

Citizen character is a character of demands of citizens. It is a written commitment of the government to the citizens about the quality of public service delivery

CHARACTERISTICS OF AN IDEAL CITIZEN CHARTER



ADVANTAGES OF CITIZEN CHARTER



DUTIES OF CIVIL SERVANTS WITH REGARD TO CITIZEN CHARTERS

- Carry out process re-engineering to remove unwanted steps
- Formulate a realistic, measurable, concrete citizen's charter after due consultation with all the stakeholders
- Provide for compensation, if service delivery is not as per standards
- Create awareness about citizen's charter
- Setup multifold grievance redressal system -
 - ✓ Toll free number
 - ✓ Online complaint registration etc.
- Establish monitoring system to keep track of public service delivery
- Reward the efficient functionaries and punish the deviants
- Special attention to physically challenged, transgender and other vulnerable communities

IN A NUTSHELL

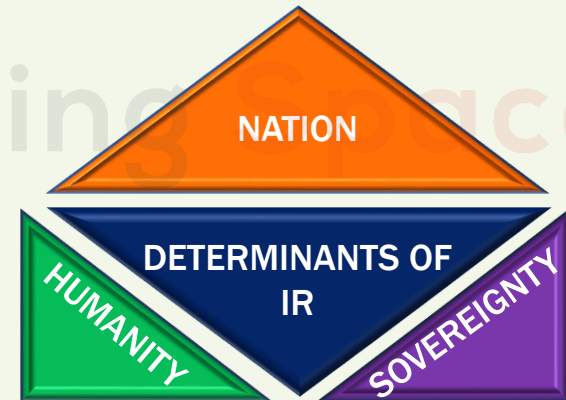
Effective implementation of citizen charter deepens the society towards matured democracy and inclusive development.

What is National Interest? Elaborate on principle ethical determinants of good and bad in International Relations. (150 Words)

National interest refers to the advantages or benefits that accrue to a nation. Thus, for every nation, the interactions with the outside world that seek to bring benefits or prevent harm to her people, assets and principles are ethical.

DETERMINANTS OF GOOD AND BAD IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

- Promotion of National interest
- Non-harming of interests of any section of humanity
- Non-interference in sovereignty of other nations



1. Promotion of National Interest

- Laws to protect the nation from crisis
E.g.: Emergency provision of constitution
- Actions that solve a nation's problems and enhance her image on global platform
E.g.: ISRO missions

2. Non-harming of human interests

- Action of one nation will have impact on people across the globe. In this regard, any action that harms human interests is unethical.
E.g.: Protectionism and Wars in Syria, Yemen etc.

3. Sovereignty

- Actions of any nation that disrupts the legitimate rights of a country to govern her people and territory is unethical.
E.g.: Interference of Russia in US elections.

FINALLY

Decisions that influence international relations are to be guided by enlightened self-interest according to which, the well-being of a nation lies in prosperity and well-being of the world.



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